making part-payment for tribal people, who are desperate to hand over the collected produce to us,' she added.[12]

- 'I am anguthachaap' (thumb impression, indicating one's illiteracy) said Zumla, a Bhil tribal with a white turban, from the village of Footiya, in Jhabua district, Madhya Pradesh. Footiya is inhabited predominantly by adivasis, or tribals, and does not have a post office, a cooperative or commercial bank, an ATM, or a public phone booth. He said he had had a bank account, but rarely used it because it took him an hour to walk to the nearest bank branch, 6 km from the village. 'I don't know how to use an ATM,' said Zumla. 'If I can't read, how do I know what buttons to press?'[13]

Farmers

Farmers and everyone dependent on agriculture suffered terribly as a result of demonetization. The entire food chain – from traders and transporters, to agricultural labour and daily wage workers, right down to small vegetable vendors – was severely impacted.

As journalist P. Sainath remarked grimly, 'Demonetization is spreading agony and misery in its wake across the countryside. *If there's been any stroke, it's the one the heart of the rural economy has suffered.*'[14]

After two consecutive years of drought in 2014–15 and 2015–16, most of India had been blessed with plentiful rainfall and a bumper summer kharif harvest. The timing of the note ban could not have come at a worse time.

Farmers who had sold their produce were stuck with worthless ₹1,000 and ₹500 notes as district co-operative banks were prohibited from accepting or changing old notes. Farmers who had not yet sold their crop were stuck as traders at the mandis and Agricultural Produce Market Committees (APMCs) had no cash to pay them. The worst hit were farmers with perishable produce – fruits and